

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD X7-0 (A)
Red 12/10/00 upl**Species:** Glossy Ibis (*Plegadis falcinellus*)**Date:** 16 April 2000**Number seen:** two**Sex:** ?**Plumage:** Alternate**Locality:** Ft. Lyon**Elevation:** about 3900'**Nearest town:** Ft. Lyon**County:** Bent**Time observed:** early morning**Duration of observation:** about three minutes for the first, four minutes for the second

Description: I was birding with others when we stopped to investigate a flock of White-faced Ibis in a flooded field at Ft. Lyon. We were all looking for a Glossy and Mark Janos found one. We studied that bird for a while. The entire flock flew off shortly before another flock came in to forage. Mark found a second Glossy in the arriving flock, which we all then studied for a while. Though these two birds probably ought to represent two records, I here describe them as one, as they were extremely similar.

The birds were obviously *Plegadis* ibises (medium-sized, long-legged wading birds with overall dark plumage with iridescence, and long, down-curved bills) in Alternate plumage (much of the neck and body were a dark chestnut) foraging in a flooded field. The important characters are facial plumage and soft part colors. The eyes were dark and the legs were dark, save for dark reddish tarso-metatarsal joints ("knees"). Each eye was set at the back of a patch of bare, dark facial skin. There was a thin border of light blue at the top and bottom edges of this bare skin, which did not connect behind the eye.

Similar species eliminated by description: The only similar species in North America is the regular White-faced Ibis. It is eliminated easily (as we had very good views of the two birds) by the precise face pattern and the soft part colors.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): The bird was not heard.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen 1000s of both North American species of *Plegadis*.

Light conditions: sun was behind me

Optical equipment used: Leica 32x

Distance, and how estimated: estimated at 35 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Mark Janos, Brandon Percival, and Chris Wood

Other observers who saw the bird independently: none

If photographed, type of equipment and film: did not photograph

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Tony Leukering". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style with a long horizontal stroke at the end.

Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 18 April and 10 December 2000 from notes that I wrote that night